

KALE REALTY

TRUST IN AI TO FIND A HOME CRATERED.

It dropped to sixteen percent this year, down from thirty. Buyers didn't get less tech savvy. They got burned.

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**FIFTY-FIVE
PERCENT OF
BUYERS WANT A
HUMAN FOR THE
MORTGAGE.**

Up from forty-six percent last year. The most expensive decision in the deal is the one buyers trust AI with the least.

AI ADOPTION WENT UP. TRUST IN IT WENT DOWN.

Cotality's 2026 AI in Housing report surveyed U.S. homebuyers between late January and early February. Trust in AI to help find a home fell fourteen percentage points, from thirty percent in 2025 to sixteen percent in 2026, even as AI tools kept showing up across more of the buying process. Fifty-five percent of buyers said they'd rather work with a person to secure a mortgage, up from forty-six percent the year before, and forty-four percent said they'd pay extra just to have a human check an AI's work. The tools got better. The willingness to hand the biggest financial decision of someone's life to a chatbot did not.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR HOW YOU MARKET YOURSELF:

- 1 Put your name on the number, not the app.**
A buyer trusts you to check the AI estimate,
- 2 not the estimate to check itself.**
- 3 Say the quiet part in your marketing.**
"I read every disclosure myself" and "I call the
- 4 lender, I don't send a bot" are differentiators now, not throwbacks.**
- 5 Lead with a transaction you walked someone through**
, not a tool you use. The receipts a
- 6 chatbot can't produce are the ones a buyer remembers.**
- 7 Offer the verification before they ask for it.**
Buyers already said they'd pay for a human
- 8 to double check AI. Be the one who offers it first.**

THE TAKEAWAY

**THE TOOLS
MULTIPLIED. THE
TRUST DIDN'T
FOLLOW.**

Be the human they still want in the room.